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Project Management 3.2

Estimating Time and Quality

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - Estimate project costs and times
  - State why estimations are used
  - Discuss the differences between different estimation methods
  - Identify the need estimations
  - Give relevant estimation examples

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Estimating Time

- Once you have the work identified, you can estimate the time it will take to complete
- Identify key tasks in your project (product breakdown structure)
- Other high urgency tasks to be carried out which will have priority over this one.
- Accidents and emergencies.
- Internal/external meetings.
- Holidays and sickness in key staff/stakeholders.
- Contact with other customers, suppliers and contractors.
- Breakdowns in equipment.
- Missed deliveries by suppliers.
- Interruptions by customers, suppliers, contractors, family, pets, co-workers etc.
- Others priorities and schedules e.g. local government planning processes.
- Quality control rejections etc.
- Unanticipated events (e.g. renovating the bathroom finding white-ants/termites in the walls).

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Estimating Quality

- **Categories of Cost of quality**

1-Internal Failure Costs.

Failures that occur before a project is deployed – equipment, product, service.

2-External Failure Costs.

Once the product or service reaches the customer

3-Appraisal Costs.

Costs incurred when complying with regulations - success or failure

4-Prevention Costs.

Any costs used to prevent quality deteriorating – and quality issues that need addressing during implementation

The total cost of quality is the sum of the four above categories.

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These estimates combined are a good start

- But they will not reflect actual time/cost/quality measures until they are closer to the projects end
- These are not the only measures, just examples
- You will have a strategy defined by the organisation.

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Seeking Authority

There are tasks that will need to be completed to seek project authority

- Assign Tasks (How will the tasks differ if more than one manager can assign tasks?)
- Select Suppliers
- De-select Suppliers
- Select Staff
- De-select Staff
- Influence Supplier Payments
- Influence Staff Remuneration (How, specifically?)
- Set Context for the Work
- Set Boundaries for the Work
- Veto Approaches
- Make Make/Buy Decisions
- Budget.

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The Project Plan

- At the beginning, all plans will be at a high level
  - Detail and estimates will be subject to change
  - The risk to the project is generally at its highest point in the beginning
  - There are likely to be negotiations and trade offs up until full authority is granted (and perhaps, even afterwards).